

# Class Notes: Alexander Friesen takes 2nd in 13th annual Kennedy Middle School Speech Tournament

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Alexander Friesen, 12, of San Mateo, holds his second-place trophy at the Kennedy Middle School Speech Tournament held April 12, in Sunnyvale.

Students from across the Bay Area gathered April 12 at Cupertino Middle School for the 13th annual Kennedy Middle School Speech Tournament — and one young San Mateo resident walked away with a top honor.

Twelve-year-old Alexander Friesen, a sixth grader at Helios School in Sunnyvale and a longtime resident of San Mateo’s Beresford Park neighborhood, earned second place in the Duo Interpretation event alongside his teammate. The performance category, known for its theatrical flair, invites pairs of students to interpret a published work through a two-person play. Alexander and his partner delivered a comedic rendition of Mario & Luigi by Ray Nesrym, a humorous take on sibling rivalry that delighted both judges and fellow competitors.

